

"This Journey is Never Truly Over, For the Ball I Carry is Always Moving": Future Obituaries and End-of-Life First Design

Jaydon Farao*
HCI Lab, Computer Science
University of Cape Town
Cape Town, Western Cape, South
Africa
frxjay002@myuct.ac.za

Ajit G. Pillai*
Affective Interactions Lab
The University of Sydney
Sydney, NSW, Australia
ajit.pillai@sydney.edu.au

Hafeni Mthoko
Independent Institute of Education
Cape Town, South Africa
hafeni.mthoko@uct.ac.za

Marly Muudeni Samuel
School of Simulation and
Visualisation
Glasgow School of Art
Glasgow, United Kingdom
m.samuel1@student.gsa.ac.uk

Manar Atwa
Licenced Tourguide/Egyptologist
Independent
Cairo, Egypt
manaratwa_anany@yahoo.com

Shaimaa Lazem
Informatics Research Institute
City of Scientific Research and
Technology Applications
New Borg El-Arab, Alexandria, Egypt
slazem@srtacity.sci.eg

Abstract

In an imagined future where plurality and interconnectedness are integral to technology development and innovation, indigenous and cultural philosophies, values, and approaches will take a centre stage in developing effective and inclusive design practices. Instead of summarizing, we invite the readers to step into the unknown with us, into an unusual paper writing and reading journey, exploring the cyclical nature of life and design. We begin, paradoxically, with our sights on the end of a chapter at CHI, and move through the difficult and inexorable, yet necessary, journey through death. The "end" being a portal through which to envision the future and re-examine the potential of Human-Computer Interaction.

CCS Concepts

• **Human-centered computing** → *Field studies*; **Participatory design**.

Keywords

indigenous practices, community, futuring, connectedness

ACM Reference Format:

Jaydon Farao, Ajit G. Pillai, Hafeni Mthoko, Marly Muudeni Samuel, Manar Atwa, and Shaimaa Lazem. 2025. "This Journey is Never Truly Over, For the Ball I Carry is Always Moving": Future Obituaries and End-of-Life First Design. In *Extended Abstracts of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA '25)*, April 26–May 01, 2025, Yokohama, Japan. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 10 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3706599.3716237>

*Both authors contributed equally to this research.

Permission to make digital or hard copies of all or part of this work for personal or classroom use is granted without fee provided that copies are not made or distributed for profit or commercial advantage and that copies bear this notice and the full citation on the first page. Copyrights for third-party components of this work must be honored. For all other uses, contact the owner/author(s).

CHI EA '25, Yokohama, Japan

© 2025 Copyright held by the owner/author(s).

ACM ISBN 979-8-4007-1395-8/25/04

<https://doi.org/10.1145/3706599.3716237>

1 Celebrating alt.CHI

As "alt.chi" track, as well as other beloved tracks come to an end [10], we invited ourselves to reflect on the alt.chi journey from the inquisitive lens of "how things/life end/s and what happens afterwards". As a collective of Global South Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) scholars, we perceive(d) alt.chi as an attempt to imagine a different brighter future for knowledge creation and dissemination at CHI. Almost ten years ago, the CHI community was reflecting on ten years of alt.chi with a panel asking, "Where is alt.chi headed, what is missing, and how could it change? [7, p. 1]". They did not, at least on paper, consider how it might end and, if so, what was envisioned "after the end". One might think that eventually alt.chi as a way of testing and experimenting with new approaches, should be partially or fully integrated at mainstream CHI, as is suggested by the steering committee [10]. Rather, from our humble observations, it has ended up being like the desired outcome of a classic "futuring" activity, a place open for critique, imagination, and intellectual indulgence. This is not to deny the impact of the participating authors, reviewers, and audience, which perhaps culminated outside of CHI. If everyone is satisfied, then indeed, we should be less sour about ending the track as it could find ways to re-create itself in different forms of formats, possibly even embracing open style access and publication away from CHI (e.g., arXiv¹). If alt.chi was even subtly a form of activism, an agenda to dismantle and interrogate conference structures, then our question or thought experiment is, "Would thinking about the end have made any difference in the approach taken to alt.chi?". We will never know. But as we value the track, and in the spirit of continuity, i.e. believing in an end always being a new beginning, and thinking about the "end" at the forefront of a new imagined alt.chi experience, we invite you to take that hypothetical end as your starting point of participating in writing the "Future Obituaries" of alt.chi. A method described in this paper. We will collect, analyze, and present your contributions in the conference slot designated "if accepted", or record it online if we are not. The collective hive mind exercise will help us better understand the nuances of the method but, more importantly,

¹<https://arxiv.org/>

could improve our understanding of futuring as a growing intellectual trend grounded in real frustrations of current systems and structures, which are increasingly becoming more challenging. The co-creation of knowledge and integrating it into this submission is our demure attempt to foreground “hope” as a possible driver of concrete actions and collective commitments. In this vein, we aim to encourage thinking beyond the despair of endings and instead embrace aspiration and a desire for collective action that drives innovation and recreation. We envision hope playing a role in how we consider what follows an ending, such as the end of alt.chi. This paper is structured according to the phases of life as inspired by the Egyptian sun god Ra, which resembles a newborn child in the morning, is full of life and power at noon, becomes older and dies in the evening, before being reborn the next morning [1, 46]. The four sections being: Birth, Life, Death, and Rebirth. Beginning with the end in mind, though, we embark through the life cycle in reverse, with Rebirth as our starting point.

2 Rebirth

The motivation of this work was a workshop that the authors had organised at PDC 2024 [19]. In this workshop, we were envisioning futures of indigeneity in HCI. At the beginning, we sought to use one of the futuring methods with our participants and asked ourselves: Why not practice what we preach and bring to the center the influence of our cultures, beliefs, and philosophies? This has proven to be a rewarding experience that is worth sharing and reflecting on with the alt.chi audience.

Future obituaries was born as a method to envision and plan for “after the end” as a way of thinking about the future. We take inspiration from a mix of Islamic and Egyptian philosophy that highly regard the “afterlife”. It enables designers, researchers, and practitioners to reflect on the cycle of life, and especially the death of the artefact, approach, framework, method, or movement that they are developing. As well as what prior knowledge and awareness of what death could bring to the table as future is discussed.

In Islam the “end” of things has a weight in how one proceeds with life. In Ancient Egypt this manifests as Anubis weighing the heart of the deceased on a scale against a feather. It could be argued that people would naturally desire to have a good legacy marking the end of their life, regardless of their belief system. And that people tend to do more good things when they become older. However, the belief in the “afterlife” is supposedly a stronger motive, as the person will be questioned on their time in life, where the good should outweigh the bad.

Particularly in the Islam faith, how things end matters the most; “العبرة بالخواتيم” and people usually pray that their best deeds come at the end, as this is a strong indicator of a happy “afterlife” and a path to heaven. The “afterlife” in Islam also has tiers, so the more good you do, the better your rank in heaven. Another motive is to pay more attention to the *quality* of the “good” you do.

2.1 Ancient Egypt and Life Cycles

Egyptian religious doctrines included three afterlife ideologies: belief in an underworld, eternal life, and rebirth of the soul. The underworld, also known as the Duat, ensured eternal life was an

important task for an ancient Egyptian. Non-royal Egyptians believed in different types of afterlife, including eternal life lived in the tomb as a ka (soul), and an afterlife lived in the Field of Reeds, the kingdom of the god Osiris. The Egyptian concept of ‘eternal life’ was often seen as being reborn indefinitely. Therefore, the souls who had lived their life elegantly were guided to Osiris to be born again. In order to achieve the ideal afterlife, many practices had to be performed during one’s life. This may have included acting justly and following the beliefs of the Egyptian creed. Additionally, the Egyptians stressed the rituals completed after an individual’s life has ended. In other words, it was the responsibility of the living to carry out the final traditions required so the dead could promptly meet their final fate. Furthermore, a person’s tomb had to be prepared ahead of the time of death, including all the material goods one might need upon resurrection. This preparation included what is to be inscribed on the walls. Since this would be a lengthy process, it means one might expect some consideration of its content while the person is alive. We also take learnings from these Egyptian inscribing practices on Pyramid walls, regarding the life lived and the mythology, to develop the attributes of our method.

2.2 The End is Our Beginning

The beginnings and ends take a different meaning in design projects. First, the beginning of a new design naturally marks an end of an old product or process, be that digital or not. The focus, especially with digital transformation, is on the problems and challenges of the status quo it has and how unfulfilling it is, hence making the case for a new design.

What if we design not to create, but to prepare for endings? What if death, so often feared, held the blueprint for our most meaningful beginnings? The end of many things can be frightening. Understandably, it can introduce anxiety and confronts us with an uncertain future. Nevertheless, the end is an important part of the life cycle of design and research. Considering how we end things is usually irrelevant to the excitement of beginning. And yet, things must end. There are various understandings of what constitutes the end of life, and many indigenous frameworks consider death and birth closely linked, with rebirth an integral part to these philosophies. Our workshop experiment showed us that embracing such a position in design encourages continuity, since design should begin from a place where the good rather than the lack of the current status quo is recognized, in an invitation to build upon it or its successes, at least conceptually. The new system could be a re-birth of an old one with arguably better features. This continuation is of importance in the discussion on systems deployed in the Global South, as it would recognise and acknowledge local knowledge, be that indigenous or not, as well as wisdom in how people generate workarounds that actually work. With this in mind, we consider the future and end as part and parcel in Future Obituaries.

2.3 Introducing Future Obituaries

In a simple form, the method invites designers and participants to envision a “future” end of a system, product, etc. and write an obituary talking about the “good” that system had. Because it all happens in the future, that “good” also becomes part of the “desired” future. What is presented here is the method’s “re-Birth” upon a

thorough and elaborated reflection after the workshop held at PDC '24 [19] refining the structure and prompts to guide the reflection process. It is open-ended to the sense that it can be used by designers, researchers, students, educators, and others to speculate on the death of their design artefacts, products, technology, research area, movements, concepts, and more.

The method as illustrated in 1 consists of an introduction followed by six steps, which can be summarized as following.

- Step 1: Describing who the obituary is about and setting the birth date and future death date
- Step 2: Describing details about birth
- Step 3: Describing details about life
- Step 4: Details about death
- Step 5: Details about rebirth
- Step 6: Collective reflection

Step 1 (In loving memory of): Describing who the obituary is about and setting the birth date and future death date In the first step, participants are asked to either collectively or individually pick a technology, product, method, research or movement they are working on. They are then asked to share the birth date, which could be now, or whenever the participants plan to launch or publish their work. The most important aspect of this step is to share the date of death, setting the scenario of the future that the participant or collective is envisioning and also setting the demise of what they are working on. This enables the participants to reflect on the amount of time predicted before the demise, giving space for the participants to be prepared to think about the life lived.

Step 2 (Birth): Now we begin from the birth, first discussing the birthplace, helping to set a scene on who are the people involved in the birth, environment and other factors that might be important. Followed by describing the scenario of birth, the needs, reasons, who it is for, and the development phase of the project.

Step 3 (Life): Osiris, was the God of afterlife and symbolised the triumph of life over death. In this part of the method, participants speculate on the trajectory of life. Inspired by the inscriptions on various tombs and autobiographies that highlighted the legacy of the deceased which included milestones and significant events from their life, we begin with mapping the legacy of the project, envisioning major impacts, followed by how the project has impacted people, including the stakeholders and community. One of the major aspects of discussing the life of the project is to reflect on possible negative impacts and ethical issues. "The Book of the Dead", an ancient Egyptian funerary text, which is also where the papyrus design of our method template comes from, consisted of a list of sins the deceased declared they had not committed, ensuring their heart would be judged favourably by Osiris. Inspired by this, we ask participants to list declarations of innocence, where they can list negative consequences, or ethical issues the project they are working on avoided. This is then followed by issues or harm caused by the project that needs to be forgiven. These two questions allows for not only considering ethical issues and negative consequences, but also thinking about issues that cannot be avoided, or issues that need to be focused on while creating the project.

Step 4 (Death): Participants then focus on the section on death, which involves the cause of death. This question enables them to reflect on the different aspects like environment, or community,

people, or natural causes of death of their projects, allowing to think about the aspired ways of ending. Some participants can also be bold and think about ways of death that were abrupt and not forecasted. Just as we discuss the impact on life, we also discuss impact on death, did the project fulfil its intended purpose and the death was eventual or did the demise affect people negatively, causing a need for something new to take its place. In "The Book of Death", one of the aspects was to discuss how the deceased will be remembered? This allows participants to reflect on what they will be known for in the future after the demise.

Step 5 (Rebirth): Egyptian obituaries were not about mourning the end of life, but rather celebrating the transition to the afterlife. Alongside the good deeds, legacy, and journey through the underworld, the inscriptions on tombs also included the successful rebirth in afterlife, which is represented through a new wave of transformation. In this section, we want the participants to reflect that death is not the end, that there is always something that replaces a technology, project or a concept. For example, what is next after the demise of their work? Exploring what the new objective of this new transformation would be given the completely different environment in the future and the impacts developed by their dead project.

Step 6 (Collective reflection): Once the participants have used the template to write a complete obituary, they can then reflect and map the trajectory of birth, life lived, death and rebirth. The holistic understanding is now ready to be integrated into the project participants are working on.

3 Death

Morbid perceptions of death are perhaps expected socially, as people grapple with their own immortality while experiencing loss. We would like to illuminate ways in which death has been ritualised in many cultures, not only as an act of mourning and remembrance, but also as a celebration. Here, we draw on Durkheim's [16] idea that rituals are bond-strengthening activities for communities. These examples highlight the intimate connection with death, birth, and the appreciation of life.

3.1 How communities move through "the end" of life

The end marking a new beginning is perhaps best symbolised by a wave. A wave oscillates back and forth, breaking differently every time it returns. However, before it can return, it must first retreat. The wave cycle must first end. The same can be argued about the concept of existence. There is a reason for birth and death to happen, and it can be perceived as a cyclical form of birth and rebirth, inextricably linked. A death rite with origins in Polynesia is the paddle-out ceremony, an ocean-based surfing funeral ritual carried out by surfing communities in Hawaii and Australia [21]. The ceremony is carried out to symbolically honour and celebrate the life of a fellow deceased surfer by placing their remains or other objects in the ocean as a form of farewell and rite of passage [21]. During the ceremony, surfing communities gather to remember, acknowledge and tell stories about the life and surfing identity of the departed who is missing from the surfing line-up. This practice, which is a rite of passage for the living and the deceased, enables the living to

Future Obituary			
Birth Birthplace Describe the birth	What was the cause of death? How will it be remembered over time?	Death What was the impact of death? How will it be remembered over time?	
Life What was the legacy (milestones and major events)? How has it impacted others?	Any harm caused, or issues that needs to be forgiven Declaration of innocence (what are the ethical considerations, potential harms, or negative consequences the design actively avoids)	Rebirth What is the new wave of transformation after death? What is the objective of the new wave?	

The loving memory of

Name:

Date of birth:

Date of death:

Figure 1: Template of future obituary

express their emotions, renew bonds, and create solidarity between surfers and the deceased through the ocean [34]. The paddle-out ceremony highlights the spatiality of death and empowers surfing communities to maintain connections with the deceased through the ocean, reinforcing the belief that the deceased continue to exist through the ocean or watery spaces.

For centuries, the Asante people of Ghana have celebrated death in high reverence [24, 54]. For them, death is often not cause for sadness, and though life is lived to the fullest and respected, the celebration of death signifies a well-lived life. Adu Addai [4, p. 33] clarifies that for the Asante people, death is not the end; instead, “death closes the door of physical, visible, bodily existence of a person and opens another door, the door to a new life.” In her book titled “Long Live the Dead: Changing Funeral Celebrations in Asante, Ghana”, de Witte [11, p. 26] also emphasises that for the Asante people, “death is like birth; the dead person is born into another life.” Death is embraced as a new beginning, a journey to the next chapter of one’s existence. This implies that there is a forward-looking philosophy associated with death, and as such futuring being an inherent part of considering the end of life.

3.2 Futuring in HCI

The Future Obituaries method is strengthened by how communities, past and present, have ritualised the end of life, but it is also

indebted to the recent trend of “futuring” in HCI. Futuring involves imagining a different future for the field, and for technology in general, hopefully one that is more participatory, inclusive, plural, and equitable [25]. They argue that design is future-oriented. Futuring activities hence foreground this fact and allow to ask critical questions such as “Which future? For whom? By whom?, etc.). Unlike other design activities, futuring does not offer solutions but rather a critique, provocation, or outcomes [26]. Design is, thus, a means to enable a discussion on the present and changing it (e.g., speculative design, fabulation, design fiction, etc.), moving away from solutionism to critiquing the status quo [25].

With this in mind, it would be remiss of us to not acknowledge the myriad of futuring approaches so closely linked and inspirational to the Future Obituaries method. Of course our work is heavily influenced by Africanfuturism [42] and Afrofuturist thought [13, 14]. The comparison, according to [42], being: “Africanfuturism is similar to “afrofuturism” in the way that blacks on the continent and in the Black Diaspora are all connected by blood, spirit, history and future. The difference is that africanfuturism is specifically and more directly rooted in African culture, history, mythology and point-of-view as it then branches into the Black Diaspora, and it does not privilege or center the West.” Black Radical Futuring in the form of Afrofuturist feminism [33], has contributed to shifting HCI-oriented imaginations towards alternative

trajectories, with a focus on unsettling power structures through speculative practice. Morris [32] describes Afrofuturist feminism as "a way of knowing and moving through the world that is a strategy for naming and navigating complicated and often vexed histories and visions of the future, one that places people of color at the center and is interested in transgressing conventional systems of power and dominance." We consider other frameworks that have shifted design trajectories, such as critical fabulations [28, 48], design fictions [40], and feminist utopias [8]. Their concerns with boundary pushing, activism, and justice-oriented design important in conceptualising what became Future Obituaries. These are but a few drops in the literary ocean of the futuring landscape of HCI, many of which, we recognise, are omitted. We believe those listed represent an adequate representation of our work and its lineages. *A note: When we grapple with existing literature and scholarship, usually, we seek opportunities to stand out. Be relevant and different. We are concerned about finding and adding value. This is, indeed, one way of achieving a so-called literature review. We, however, choose to disengage from the urge to agree/disagree with previous work. Instead, we are "staying with our trouble" [22], of our belief in a plural future where co-existence might be undermined by the tendency to compare with existing work. We chose to depart way and adopt a position where we accept the work we have come across as a part of the past that inevitably informs our present and future.*

4 Life

To consider the ways in which our approach, Future Obituaries, can be brought to life productively in our work as HCI researchers, we are called to lean on the foundation of our literary ancestors for inspiration. We begin by introducing how discomfort and tension can be constructively leveraged to promote innovation and alternative thinking. Thereafter, we consider the effectiveness of traditional approaches in HCI before looking outwards at how peripheral concepts and practices have shifted how we "do" HCI research. Lastly, we specifically focus on indigeneity and its diverse iterations, how its fluid characterisation offers opportunity for futuring that relies on the uncertain and indefinable. Opening portals for pluriversal understandings and narrowing in on the proposed approach as a means of transporting ourselves and our community collaborators towards alternative and creative destinations.

4.1 From discomfort to discovery

Globally, we have begun to reckon with the historical alienation and discrimination of indigenous communities. With the recognition of first peoples, land, language, colonialism (and its tools: racism and capitalism), and the continuous fight of marginalised groups for their inalienable rights, we have, rightly, been called to respond to prior and current transgressions on indigenous peoples' rights. The CHI community has not been immune to such challenges and criticisms as its community becomes more global and aware of its impact on the communities it engages with [27]. That said, CHI has also offered opportunities to explore alternative and newly purposed approaches to its research vocabulary, including land acknowledgements [44] and rethinking methods [29, 37], as it seeks to constantly re-invent and grapple with its existence in an ever-changing global landscape [6].

Discomfort has often been a catalyst for inspiring a shift towards an innovative and desired future [12, 17]. Participatory Design, as frequently referenced, flourished in Scandinavian workplaces where a discomfort with top-down approaches and new technologies, combined with a dissatisfaction of socio-political realities, sparked a communal shift aimed at democratising design [3, 9, 18, 20]. Discomfort and conflict, can thus be constructively leveraged to pave alternative ways of being and doing. For us, it is important to reckon with the current social and cultural landscapes globally, and that of CHI, in an effort to promote continuous reflection of our work and its impact. When embracing indigeneity as a guide to pushing boundaries and inviting alternative futures, we have to sit with the history of colonial conquest and domination of indigenous peoples and cultures [19]. Our approach introduces discomfort in two ways. Firstly, as mentioned, centring indigeneity challenges us to consider the many ways in which current practices and ideas maintain dominant western epistemologies. We are intentionally grappling with the history of HCI and which direction the field will go to next. Secondly, our method focuses on death, an inevitable stage of life that is often difficult to discuss. We use these discomforts as points of departure for the futuring practice titled Future Obituaries. To do so we rely on this paper's literary ancestors. Work that has already emerged within HCI research, which has either included indigenous voices and contributions, or advanced the way we do HCI research by embracing indigeneity.

4.2 Indigeneity and its iterations in HCI research

In a special issue for the International Journal of Human-Computer Interaction titled "Reframing HCI Through Local and Indigenous Perspectives" the editors describe "tensions" between local cultures and practices; and the values and assumptions of the HCI discipline [2]. This issue is one of the first to centre HCI work and indigenous perspectives broadly, offering valuable insights and alternative viewpoints to HCI. Of particular interest here is the contribution by Winschiers-Theophilus et al. [58] which envisions an "Afro-centric Indigenous HCI Paradigm". The authors skilfully subvert dominant, western epistemologies and provide space for alternatives by leveraging the knowledge of African scholars, encouraging researchers to challenge their standpoints. An approach adopted by [19] to explore how Ubuntu, a communal philosophy originating in Southern Africa, can guide HCI research practically in an attempt to bridge the divide between theory and practice when it concerns indigenous approaches. HCI research over the past decade has provided similar contributions that prioritises pluriversality [47], intersectionality [59], and decolonisation [30], all expanding world-views and possibilities for conducting research.

Human-Computer Interaction research that considers indigeneity has focused on the inclusion of indigenous people in their research to better understand technologies and their effect on underserved and under-resourced populations [23, 31, 41, 55]. In other words, HCI *for* indigenous people. Taking indigeneity in HCI a step further, there has been an increase in work that centres indigenous practices as integral to HCI research *with* indigenous people. The work done by Muashekele et al. [36–39] represents a thoughtful decolonial approach to doing participatory HCI research through

futuring and remaining connected with the past. They challenge speculative design approaches with indigenous communities and expand temporal understandings, exposing alternative ways to imagine the future. It is on these works that our approach is in communication with, as a means of shifting ourselves and our research communities to uncomfortable but enriching futures.

4.3 Reimagining the "Traditional"

There has been a continued call for critical research agendas that challenge dominant HCI paradigms, which are often centred predominantly on western epistemologies [57]. Such calls are not to say that western epistemologies should be eliminated, but rather understanding the limitations of, and over reliance on, select paradigms which are not always suited in all circumstances. Winschiers-Theophilus [56] draw our attention to the importance of context/cultural-specific [5], community-driven design approaches and particularly the need and space for integrating indigenous epistemologies into HCI work. This desire for a sensitivity to difference may bring about a more meaningful and impactful experience [5]. It is in this difference that our experiences of reality challenges traditional HCI paradigms. Existing western-centric HCI frameworks when applied in non-western contexts amplify the inherent biases and assumptions that are embedded in such frameworks. Every technology and every design carries with it assumptions that may not be appropriate in different cultural contexts [43]. Thus, failing to account for local cultural practices and values often leads to a cultural bias [30] limiting the desired value that western-centric HCI frameworks hope to achieve. Furthermore, western-centric approaches tend to foreground certain ways of knowing and being which not only can marginalise indigenous knowledge systems [35, 57] but may also disrupt local ways of life [57]. The risks of a lack of contextual relevance and the pressure to conform to one set of practices or standards may limit local innovation and the development of HCI work that suits the desires of non-western communities.

4.4 in-dih-jen-uhs *adjective*

Definition(s): plentiful

It comes as little surprise that there is no agreed upon or understood definition of indigenous people. Most descriptions include self-identification; and descendents of populations who resided in regions before colonial conquest [52]. There are no "authoritative" definitions as outlined by indigenous people themselves, thus it seems contradictory to limit oneself to the constraints of language for such a diverse and pluriversal aspect of society and being, especially if self-determination is understood as integral to indigeneity. Indeed, ascribing indigenous as a term to populations is as a response to colonial conquest and subsequent institutionalisation via categorisation, state boundaries, and western legal frameworks. Processes introduced to counter indigenous practices and epistemologies. As researchers, we often strive to name and describe terms and ideas, but here we choose to proceed cautiously, acknowledging the potential for othering and alienation. We choose to encourage the discomfort of the undefined and leverage it to shift our imaginations when considering our epistemological frameworks as HCI researchers.

4.5 The Labour of Working with Pluralistic Futuring

As a research team, we are united by a shared commitment to decolonising the field of HCI and embedding Indigenous and cultural knowledge into its theory and practice. We bring to this work a rich tapestry of lived experiences, geographical locations, and cultural backgrounds, having lived, studied and worked in Egypt, Nigeria, South Africa, Namibia, U.K, India, Europe, North America, and Australia. Our diverse journeys have shaped our understanding of the world and our commitment to research that challenges dominant narratives and amplifies marginalised voices.

Our collective experience spans western academic institutions and deep connections to African and Arab HCI communities. This intersectional positioning allows us to critically examine the limitations of western-centric approaches in HCI and advocate for the inclusion of diverse cultural perspectives and philosophies. We recognise the importance of prioritising local knowledge and engaging in intercultural dialogue to create a more pluralistic and inclusive future for HCI. We are informed by decolonisation theory, feminist perspectives, and a deep respect for Indigenous knowledge systems. We acknowledge the complexities and nuances of navigating our own positionalities as researchers, recognising both the privileges and limitations we hold. Our personal experiences with grief, loss, and cultural identity have profoundly influenced our approach to develop Future Obituaries as a method for centring end-of-life first considerations in design.

Through our collaborative efforts, we seek to contribute to a growing movement within HCI that values diverse ways of knowing, challenges systemic biases, and promotes social justice. We believe that by embracing a decolonial lens and incorporating Indigenous and cultural knowledge, we can create a space within HCI that is more responsive to the needs and aspirations of diverse communities around the world.

Focusing on indigeneity, pluralism, and under-represented theories is not a trivial task. While we acknowledge the work done by previous scholars, we also recognise that it takes consistent effort and resolve to achieve it in an environment intensely preconditioned on structures (often) antithetical to the indigenous people and their values. The act of futuring with indigeneity does not come naturally to "local" designers and scholars, as per our humble experience, because the academic and funding structures we inhabit encourage and value western-oriented forms of expression as knowledge creation and might threaten exclusion if we do otherwise[30]. It takes welcoming alternative spaces where all voices are welcome. Actually, it takes more than that. It takes time and effort to truly learn what it means to embrace indigeneity and not just "invite [diversity] people to the party or dance [inclusion]", but to re-design, re-birth the party so that everyone may experience it [decolonisation] [15, 51]. The difficulties of challenging the existing structures should also not prevent us as scholars or activists from pursuing meaningful work. In fact, it may be that the discomfort of the unknown is the encouragement to continue. That is what worked for us through the creation of Future Obituaries.



Figure 2: The six scarabs: [Clockwise from top left] Jaydon Farao, Ajit G. Pillai, Hafeni Mthoko, Marly Muudeni Samuel, Manar Atwa, Shaimaa Lazem

5 Birth

One of the pillars of indigenous communities on the African continent is oral storytelling. African folktales, specifically, have habitually been told in the evening as community members gathered around the fire, listening intently to a story with no author, just a storyteller. The tales often contain a didactic purpose and are filled with ideas and details that "explain the nature of society" [60, p. 17]. Furthermore, preserving a relationship to, and reliance on, African folktales, Kenyan author and postcolonial theorist Ngũgĩ wa Thiong'o writes, is a political act [49]. That only through deliberate and consistent efforts to maintain our connection with the past and leverage African folktales as a dominant "medium of cultural transmission", can African culture be safeguarded from western influence [53]. These tales often include animals and nature as primary, conscious characters often to reflect a core human lesson [45, 50]; and it is with this in mind that this paper reaches its end. We invite you now to sit with us around the fire, lending your imagination, as the story of the scarab beetle, believed to be a symbol of rebirth and regeneration in ancient Egypt, is told to communicate the takeaways of our approach presented above. The characters and their views represent the thoughts of the authors as

experienced and articulated when conceptualising this paper.

The scarab rolled their ball, the size of a peanut, along the dusty path, each roll triggering a memory as they moved toward the funeral of Alta the Chameleon, affectionately known as Alt Chi. It was said that Alt Chi, master of change and transformation, had lived many lives, each one different from the past, each one a lesson from the fleeting dance of life and death. On the way, the scarab walked past the river, who noticed the scarab and beckoned them nearer. "Ah, little beetle, rolling your ball with purpose. Where do you carry it and what do you seek in its path?" asked the river.

"I carry this ball to a place of stillness in memory of the chameleon," replied the scarab. "I seek to understand what I have learned and to share the knowledge of life's movement. I roll it as I roll the stories, letting them carry me forward, unsure of where they will end..."

"Little one," interjected the river, "You must learn that there is no true end. My waters do not cease; they move through time and space. What will you do when your ball reaches

its final place? Do not think only of where it ends. The flow of ideas, like my current, is always moving — always seeking new shores. And so too must your work, to shape what will come, not just what has been."

The scarab paused for a moment then continued rolling their ball, understanding now that "the end" is, similarly, a pause. It then continues to flow, connected with its past trajectories and where it began.

The scarab, with the ball now the size of an egg, continued their journey once more and turned towards the open plain where the goose, flying overhead, called out, "Greetings, small scarab, who moves with steady determination. What is it you roll below you, and why do you roll it toward that distant place? I have flown far and wide, and I see what lies ahead. Let me share my vision with you."

The scarab, comforted by the goose's shadow, cried out, "I carry stories, both old and new, that they may be transformed and grow. I roll them to the chameleon's memorial. What will I learn as I move toward the horizon?"

"Ah, scarab, you carry not just a ball, but a whole world. You move through a landscape shaped by many, yet you must ask yourself: whose voices are you carrying with you? Who has shaped the path you walk upon, and who has been left behind? The work you do is not just yours; it is the labor of many. This process is a journey that requires courage and effort, just as you must roll your ball forward. To redesign and reimagine the future, you must hear the voices that have been silenced, give room to the stories that have been erased, and confront the labor that is necessary for true transformation."

"Such wisdom," thought the scarab. "I see that now," replied the scarab with gratitude. "I carry my ball as though it is my own, but it is shaped by all who have come before me, including my friend, the chameleon."

"Exactly, young scarab. To collect these stories, to carry and grow this ball, is to make room for unheard realities. It is work, and it requires not just thought but action. The courage to share parts of yourself, even through discomfort, and reimagine the world, will transform not only your path but the paths of those who walk with you."

With that, the goose flew off, leaving the scarab, their apple-sized ball now requiring more effort, scorched by the sun. Just then, five other scarabs, each pushing their own ball arrived through the tall grass. The group joined the scarab, relieved to have some companionship.

The sun looked down on them and sang, "Ah, scarabs, you who carry the weight of stories past. I see you come with your balls, rolling it along the earth's path. Know that I rise every day to renew the world, just as you renew the stories you carry. Come, let me show you how light can shape the darkness of the past into new possibilities of the future."

"We roll the ball, knowing that it carries more than just the weight of the past," said the scarab. "We carry the lessons of many lives, hoping to transform them into something that will shine with new light. But how can the darkness of the past be turned into something bright?"

"The past is never lost, little beetles. Just as I rise each day

to bring light to the world, so too can the past be renewed, reborn in the light of understanding. In moments of stillness, when the ball rests and the day ends, the lesson is clear: endings are not something to fear. In fact, they are what make the future possible. The new day comes because the old one has passed."

With the sun at its peak, the scarabs moved swiftly to make it in time for the funeral. Glancing upwards, the scarab parted with the sun, saying, "I see that now. The past is not to be feared, but celebrated. It is the light of the present that will shape the future. We must let go of our fear of endings, for in them is the power to bring about the next beginning."

After a while the scarabs reached the place where the chameleon was to be laid to rest. The scarab's ball resembled a large baobab fruit now, the others a small fig, as they guided them through the gathering crowd to lay at the memorial. "I have learned much on this journey," the scarab thought. "And now I lay this ball of memories and life, together with my fellow scarabs, beside the chameleon's resting place. This journey is never truly over, for the ball we carry is always moving, always being shaped by the lessons we learn, by the stories we gather, by the voices we listen to. The end, merely an opportunity for reimagining the future, rebirthing the past."

Acknowledgments

Jaydon Farao was financially supported by the Hasso Plattner Institute for Digital Engineering, through the HPI Research School at UCT.

References

- [1] Nour Abdel Hamid and Amany Abdel Rehim. 2016. The Manifestations of Care and Happiness for the New-born in Ancient Egypt and its Assimilation to the Inherited Folklore. *The Conference Book of the General Union of Arab Archeologists* 19, 19 (Dec. 2016), 171–205. <https://doi.org/10.21608/cguaa.2016.29700>
- [2] Jose Abdelnour-Nocera, Torkil Clemmensen, and Masaaki Kurosu. 2013. Reframing HCI through local and indigenous perspectives. *International Journal of Human-Computer Interaction* 29, 4 (2013), 201–204.
- [3] Muhammad Adamu and Shaimaa Lazem. 2024. Enough with Newness: On Re-centering African "Users" in HCI Research and Design. In *Proceedings of the Participatory Design Conference 2024: Exploratory Papers and Workshops - Volume 2* (Sibu, Malaysia) (PDC '24). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 24–30. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3661455.3669866>
- [4] Emmanuel Adu Addai. 2016. *End-of-life care, death and funerals of the Asante: An ethical and theological vision*. Ph. D. Dissertation. Boston College, School of Theology and Ministry. <http://dlib.bc.edu/islandora/object/bc-ir:106929>
- [5] Yoko Akama, Penny Hagen, and Desna Whaanga-Schollum. 2019. Problematizing Replicable Design to Practice Respectful, Reciprocal, and Relational Co-designing with Indigenous People. *Design and Culture* 11, 1 (2019), 59–84. <https://doi.org/10.1080/17547075.2019.1571306> arXiv:https://doi.org/10.1080/17547075.2019.1571306
- [6] Adriana Alvarado Garcia, Juan F. Maestre, Manuhua Barcham, Marilyn Iriarte, Marisol Wong-Villares, Oscar A Lemus, Palak Dudani, Pedro Reynolds-Cuellar, Ruotong Wang, and Teresa Cerratto Pargman. 2021. Decolonial Pathways: Our Manifesto for a Decolonizing Agenda in HCI Research and Design. In *Extended Abstracts of the 2021 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA '21)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 1–9. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3411763.3450365>
- [7] Morgan G. Ames, Barry Brown, Sidney S. Fels, Silvia Lindtner, Daniela K. Rosner, and Roel Vertegaal. 2015. 10 Years of alt.chi: Reflections and Outlook. In *Proceedings of the 33rd Annual ACM Conference Extended Abstracts on Human Factors in Computing Systems (Seoul, Republic of Korea) (CHI EA '15)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 839. <https://doi.org/10.1145/2702613.2736010>

- [8] Shaowen Bardzell. 2018. Utopias of Participation: Feminism, Design, and the Futures. *ACM Trans. Comput.-Hum. Interact.* 25, 1, Article 6 (Feb. 2018), 24 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3127359>
- [9] Susanne Bodker and Morten Kyng. 2018. Participatory Design that Matters—Facing the Big Issues. *ACM Trans. Comput.-Hum. Interact.* 25, 1, Article 4 (Feb. 2018), 31 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3152421>
- [10] CHI Steering Committee. 2024. CHI Conferences Format & Finances Part Four: Proposed Format Changes for Future CHI Conferences – CHI Steering Committee. <https://chi.acm.org/finances-and-format-proposals/>
- [11] M. de Witte. 2001. *Long Live the Dead! Changing Funeral Celebrations in Asante, Ghana*. AmsterdamAksant Academic Publishers. <https://dare.uva.nl/search?identifier=61ca5696-5d24-41c8-9725-6956237bade5>
- [12] J. DeGraff and S. DeGraff. 2017. *The Innovation Code: The Creative Power of Constructive Conflict*. Berrett-Koehler Publishers.
- [13] Mark Dery. 1994. Black to the Future: Interviews with Samuel R. Delany, Greg Tate, and Tricia Rose. In *Flame Wars*, Mark Dery (Ed.). Duke University Press, 179–222. <https://doi.org/10.1215/9780822396765-010>
- [14] Mark Dery (Ed.). 1994. *Flame Wars: The Discourse of Cyberculture*. Duke University Press. <https://doi.org/10.1515/9780822396765>
- [15] Tunstall Dori. 2020. Decolonizing Design | Dori Tunstall. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jjLV1vVm9bc>
- [16] Emile Durkheim. 2016. The elementary forms of religious life. In *Social theory re-wired*, Daniel Winchester Wesley Longhofer (Ed.). Routledge, 52–67. <https://doi.org/10.4324/9781315775357>
- [17] Barbara Dyer and X. Michael Song. 1998. Innovation Strategy and Sanctioned Conflict: A New Edge in Innovation? *Journal of Product Innovation Management* 15, 6 (Nov. 1998), 505–519. <https://doi.org/10.1111/1540-5885.1560505>
- [18] Jaydon Farao, Hafeni Mthoko, and Melissa Densmore. 2024. Transformative Narratives: Fostering Ubuntu-Inspired Participatory Design Practices. In *Proceedings of the Participatory Design Conference 2024: Exploratory Papers and Workshops - Volume 2* (Sibu, Malaysia) (PDC '24). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 107–113. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3661455.3669878>
- [19] Jaydon Farao, Ajit G. Pillai, Hafeni Mthoko, Shaimaa Lazem, and Marly Samuel. 2024. Embracing Ubuntu: Mapping Communal Ecologies in Participatory Design for HCI Practice. In *Proceedings of the Participatory Design Conference 2024: Exploratory Papers and Workshops - Volume 2* (Sibu, Malaysia) (PDC '24). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 225–229. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3661455.3669899>
- [20] Aakash Gautam. 2024. Reconfiguring Participatory Design to Resist AI Realism. In *Proceedings of the Participatory Design Conference 2024: Exploratory Papers and Workshops - Volume 2* (Sibu, Malaysia) (PDC '24). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 31–36. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3661455.3669867>
- [21] Margaret Gibson and Mardi Frost. 2019. Surfing and ocean-based death ritual: the paddle-out ceremony. *Mortality* 24, 3 (2019), 304–318. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13576275.2018.1461816>
- [22] Donna J. Haraway. 2016. *Staying with the Trouble: Making Kin in the Chthulucene*. Duke University Press. <https://doi.org/10.1215/9780822373780>
- [23] Nur Huda Jaafar, Zuriati Ismail, Nur Diana Zamani, Mazlyda Abd Rahman, and Rashidah Mokhtar. 2024. Empowering Indigenous Pupils: Enhancing Cyber Security Awareness Through Interactive Gaming Experiences. In *Proceedings of the 2024 10th International Conference on Frontiers of Educational Technologies* (Malacca, Malaysia) (ICFET '24). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 96–103. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3678392.3678397>
- [24] John Kwame Adu Jack, Emmanuel Kojo Amoah, and Eric Hope. 2020. Estimating the Financial Costs of Funeral Celebrations in Ghana: (A Case Study of Greater Accra, Central and Ashanti Regions). *International journal of business and social research* 10, 2 (2020), 01–17. <https://doi.org/10.18533/ijbsr.v10i2.1266>
- [25] Tom Jenkins, Vasiliki Tsaknaki, Noura Howell, Laurens Boer, Richmond Y. Wong, Nadia Campo Woytuk, Peter Kun, and Marie Louise Juul Søndergaard. 2024. Mapping Futures and Futuring in HCI/Design. In *Companion Publication of the 2024 ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference* (IT University of Copenhagen, Denmark) (DIS '24 Companion). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 458–461. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3656156.3658384>
- [26] Sandjar Kozubae, Chris Elsdén, Noura Howell, Marie Louise Juul Søndergaard, Nick Merrill, Britta Schulte, and Richmond Y. Wong. 2020. Expanding Modes of Reflection in Design Futuring. In *Proceedings of the 2020 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* (Honolulu, HI, USA) (CHI '20). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 1–15. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3313831.3376526>
- [27] Neha Kumar. 2023. About CHI in Hawai'i. <https://medium.com/sigchi/about-chi-in-hawaii-a0db01c90a95>
- [28] Shaimaa Lazem, Muhammad Sadi Adamu, Yasmeen Abdrabou, Chris Muashekele, Sheena Erete, Jakita Thomas, Hafeni Mthoko, Heike Winschiers-Theophilus, Nicola Bidwell, Aderonke Sakpere, and Anicia Peters. 2024. What if?.. Fabulating African HCI Futures within the Veil of HCI. In *Proceedings of the 4th African Human Computer Interaction Conference* (East London, South Africa) (AfriCHI '23). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 295–299. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3628096.3629074>
- [29] Shaimaa Lazem, Muhammad Sadi Adamu, Yasmeen Abdrabou, Chris Muashekele, Sheena Erete, Jakita Thomas, Hafeni Mthoko, Heike Winschiers-Theophilus, Nicola Bidwell, Aderonke Sakpere, and Anicia Peters. 2024. What if?.. Fabulating African HCI Futures within the Veil of HCI. In *Proceedings of the 4th African Human Computer Interaction Conference* (East London, South Africa) (AfriCHI '23). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 295–299. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3628096.3629074>
- [30] Shaimaa Lazem, Danilo Giglito, Makuochi Samuel Nkwo, Hafeni Mthoko, Jessica Upani, and Anicia Peters. 2022. Challenges and Paradoxes in Decolonising HCI: A Critical Discussion. *Computer Supported Cooperative Work (CSCW)* 31, 2 (June 2022), 159–196. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10606-021-09398-0>
- [31] Laurence Lloyd-Jones, Claudia Ott, Holger Regenbrecht, and Hundefindmi Whaanga. 2024. Virtual Reality Pōwhiri—Practicing an indigenous welcoming ceremony. In *Proceedings of the 35th Australian Computer-Human Interaction Conference* (Wellington, New Zealand) (OzCHI '23). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 550–563. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3638380.3638396>
- [32] Susana Morris. 2014. Androids, Shape Shifters, and Vampires: Black Women's Afrofuturist Feminist Cultural Productions. <http://hdl.handle.net/1853/51305>
- [33] Susana M. Morris. 2012. Black Girls Are from the Future: Afrofuturist Feminism in Octavia E. Butler's "Fledgling". *Women's Studies Quarterly* 40, 3/4 (2012), 146–166. <http://www.jstor.org/stable/23333483>
- [34] Patrick Moser. 2021. Origins of the paddle-out ceremony. *TEXT* 25, Special 65 (Oct. 2021). <https://doi.org/10.52086/001c.28070>
- [35] Hafeni Mthoko, Muhammad Adamu, Shaimaa Lazem, and Anicia Peters. 2023. Including critical Approaches in HCI Curricula: A provocation. In *Proceedings of the 5th Annual Symposium on HCI Education, EduCHI 2023, Hamburg, Germany, 28 April 2023*. ACM, 49–54. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3587399.3587413>
- [36] Chris Muashekele, Kasper Rodil, Heike Winschiers-Theophilus, and Shorty Kandjengo. 2024. Recovering lost futures of the past: Situating alternative futures within an indigenous Afrocentric orientation and past trajectory. In *Proceedings of the Participatory Design Conference 2024: Full Papers - Volume 1* (Sibu, Malaysia) (PDC '24). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 28–40. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3666094.3666101>
- [37] Chris Muashekele, Kasper Rodil, Heike Winschiers-Theophilus, and Christof Magoath. 2023. Futuring from an indigenous community stance: projecting temporal duality from the past into the future. In *Extended Abstracts of the 2023 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* (Hamburg, Germany) (CHI EA '23). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Article 147, 7 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3544549.3585761>
- [38] Chris Muashekele, Heike Winschiers-Theophilus, Kasper Rodil, and Alphons Koruhama. 2023. Ancestral and Cultural Futuring: Speculative Design in an Indigenous ovaHimba context. In *Proceedings of the 11th International Conference on Communities and Technologies* (Lahti, Finland) (C&T '23). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 85–95. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3593743.3593761>
- [39] Chris Muashekele, Heike Winschiers-Theophilus, Kasper Rodil, and Uariaike Mbinge. 2024. Infusing Futuring into Community-based Co-design: A Pathway to Innovative Technology Design with Indigenous Communities in Africa. In *Proceedings of the 4th African Human Computer Interaction Conference* (AfriCHI '23). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 151–161. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3628096.3629049>
- [40] Michael Muller, Jeffrey Bardzell, Eunjeong Cheon, Norman Makoto Su, Eric P. S. Baumer, Casey Fiesler, Ann Light, and Mark Blythe. 2020. Understanding the Past, Present, and Future of Design Fictions. In *Extended Abstracts of the 2020 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* (Honolulu, HI, USA) (CHI EA '20). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 1–8. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3334480.3375168>
- [41] Rennie Naidoo and Funmi Adebisin. 2024. Analyzing Digital Practices in Indigenous Communities: A Foucauldian Sociotechnical Demarginalizing Method. In *Proceedings of the 4th African Human Computer Interaction Conference* (East London, South Africa) (AfriCHI '23). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 142–150. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3628096.3629048>
- [42] Nnedi Okorafor. 2019. Africanfuturism Defined. <http://nnedi.blogspot.com/2019/10/africanfuturism-defined.html>
- [43] Siiri Paananen, Mari Suoheimo, and Jonna Häkikilä. 2022. Decolonizing design with technology in cultural heritage contexts-systematic literature review. In *Congress of the International Association of Societies of Design Research*. Springer, 1839–1855. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-981-19-4472-7_119
- [44] Sachin R Pendse, Daniel Nkemelu, Nicola J Bidwell, Sushrut Jadhav, Soumitra Pathare, Munmun De Choudhury, and Neha Kumar. 2022. From Treatment to Healing: Envisioning a Decolonial Digital Mental Health. In *Proceedings of the 2022 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* (CHI '22). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 1–23. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3491102.3501982>
- [45] Kwesi Yankah Philip M. Peek. 2004. *African Folklore: An Encyclopedia*. Routledge, New York City, NY, USA. 6 pages. <https://doi.org/10.4324/9780203493144>
- [46] Alexandre Piankoff. 1953. *La Création du Disque Solaire (Creation and the Sun Disk)*. Institut Français d' Archeologie Orientale, Cairo, Egypt.

- [47] Mohammad Rashidujjaman Rifat, Ayesha Bhimdiwala, Ananya Bhattacharjee, Amna Batool, Dipto Das, Nusrat Jahan Mim, Abdullah Hasan Safir, Sharifa Sultana, Taslima Akter, C Estelle Smith, et al. 2023. Many Worlds of Ethics: Ethical Pluralism in CSCW. In *Companion Publication of the 2023 Conference on Computer Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing*. 490–496. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3584931.3611291>
- [48] Daniela Rosner. 2018. *Critical fabulations: reworking the methods and margins of design*. The MIT Press, Cambridge, Massachusetts.
- [49] Reinhard W. Sander, Bernth Lindfors, and Lynette Cintrón. 2005. *Ngũgĩ wa Thiong'o speaks: interviews with the Kenyan writer*. James Currey, Oxford.
- [50] Enongene Mirabeau Sone. 2018. The Folktale and Social Values in Traditional Africa. *Eastern African Literary and Cultural Studies* 4, 2 (June 2018), 142–159. <https://doi.org/10.1080/23277408.2018.1485314>
- [51] Elizabeth Tunstall. 2023. *Decolonizing design: a cultural justice guidebook*. The MIT Press, Cambridge, Massachusetts.
- [52] United Nations. 2017. *Factsheet: Indigenous Peoples and the United Nations Human Rights System*. The Ocean Conference, United Nations, New York. Issue 9. <https://www.ohchr.org/sites/default/files/Documents/Publications/fs9Rev.2.pdf>
- [53] Mansuru Usmanu Mohmukwe. 2024. Afrocentricity and Afro-dystopia: Defining the literary motive of Ngũgĩ wa Thiong'o. *SSRN Electron. J.* (2024).
- [54] Sjaak Van Der Geest. 2000. Funerals for the Living: Conversations with Elderly People in Kwahu, Ghana. *African Studies Review* 43, 3 (Dec. 2000), 103. <https://doi.org/10.2307/525071>
- [55] Morgan Vigil-Hayes, Lakshmi Panguluri, Harry Dececco, Md Nazmul Hossain, Ann Collier, Darold Joseph, and Ashish Amresh. 2024. ICT-facilitated Health Interventions for Indigenous Communities: A Critical Literature Review. *ACM J. Responsib. Comput.* 1, 4, Article 25 (Nov. 2024), 26 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3687133>
- [56] Heike Winschiers-Theophilus. 2022. Bridging worlds: indigenous knowledge in the digital world. In *Proceedings of the 22nd ACM/IEEE Joint Conference on Digital Libraries (Cologne, Germany) (JCDL '22)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Article 1, 2 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3529372.3538820>
- [57] Heike Winschiers-Theophilus and Nicola J Bidwell. 2013. Toward an Afro-Centric indigenous HCI paradigm. *International Journal of Human-Computer Interaction* 29, 4 (2013), 243–255. <https://doi.org/10.1080/10447318.2013.765763>
- [58] Heike Winschiers-Theophilus, Naska Winschiers-Goagoses, Kasper Rodil, Edwin Blake, Tariq Zaman, Gereon Koch Kapuire, and Richard Kamukuenjandje. 2013. Moving away from Erindi-roukambe: Transferability of a rural community-based co-design. (2013), 11.
- [59] Pamela J Wisniewski, Neha Kumar, Christine Bassem, Sarah Clinch, Susan M Dray, Geraldine Fitzpatrick, Cliff Lampe, Michael Muller, and Anicia N Peters. 2018. Intersectionality as a Lens to Promote Equity and Inclusivity within SIGCHI. In *Extended Abstracts of the 2018 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. 1–6. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3170427.3186324>
- [60] Okogbule Wonodi. 1965. The role of folk tales in African society. *Africa report* 10, 11 (1965), 17.